EDITION 33

I budget AI credits the way I would manage a cash position.

Deploying AI costs money per run. If you do not meter it, it drains quietly. I learned that the embarrassing way.

A **7**-part breakdown

SWIPE >>>>

0101 / 07

The setup.

The unglamorous truth about deploying AI: it costs money per run. Treat that cost as free and it will quietly drain the whole thing.

0202 / 07

How I found out.

I'd planned a build assuming the image generation was unlimited and free. The unlimited tier had quietly expired. Every image was now metered.

0303 / 07

The damage.

My balance dropped by a third in a single day of normal activity. A plan I'd called roughly zero cost was on track to starve the daily jobs before the next refresh.

0404 / 07

A per-run cap.

Each daily job now has a hard ceiling on what it can spend. Go over, it draws down or drops to draft mode. It never silently burns the reserve.

0505 / 07

A protected reserve.

A fixed pool is fenced off for the highest-value output. Nothing routine can touch it. Same logic as ring-fencing cash you've already promised elsewhere.

0606 / 07

Just in time, with a tripwire.

Don't pre-generate everything. Make the expensive asset only when it's going out. And if the balance crosses a line before a set date, that's a decision point, not a surprise.

0707 / 07

Save this.

Know the burn rate. Protect the reserve. Never let a routine process spend the money you set aside for the important thing.

THE TAKEAWAY

Found this useful?

Repost to share it with your network, and follow for weekly breakdowns of the agentic payments stack.

◆ Joseph Bankole